



Rooted in Rhythm:

*A Gentle Guide to Caring for Your
Body Through Every Hormonal Phase*



Work with your hormones, not against them.

Your body is beautifully cyclical, which means it's not meant to run at the same pace every day.

By honoring, your hormonal rhythm, you can align your eating, fasting, and energy to feel grounded, nourish, and strong all month long.

This is your invitation to listen, support, and move in rhythm with your body.

Understanding Fasting, Metabolism& the Female Physiology

A woman's body is uniquely sensitive to nutritional timing, calorie restriction, and fasting. Hormones like estrogen, progesterone, and cortisol all interact with your metabolism, influencing how your body uses fat, maintains muscle, and regulates appetite.

When you fast or restrict calories too aggressively, especially during low-hormone phases, cortisol rises and thyroid function can slow, leading to fatigue, anxiety, or irregular cycles. Thus, instead of rigid fasting, women benefit from a **rhythmic approach** — aligning food intake with hormonal changes.

Your body's needs and responses shift throughout the cycle, so the way you fast and nourish yourself can feel different at each phase. For example, during the follicular phase, when estrogen begins to rise, mild fasting can feel supportive, often enhancing insulin sensitivity and energy. As you move into the luteal and pre-menstrual phases, shorter fasting windows or regular meals help stabilize blood sugar and support emotional balance. Metabolism also increases slightly during the luteal phase as the body prepares for potential implantation, which explains stronger hunger cues and cravings.

This is not a sign of weakness. It's your physiology working perfectly. By tuning into these rhythms and nourishing accordingly, women can support hormonal health, energy, and longevity while maintaining a sustainable relationship with food.

Living in Sync With Your Cycle

Menstrual/ Early Follicular Phase(Days 1–10)

Your body is renewing. Estrogen begins to rise, and your body is calling for rest and replenishment.

Give yourself grace. This is your reset phase.

During this phase, gentle support goes a long way. Here are a few ways to care for yourself:

- Focus on nourishing, nutrient-dense foods. Think soups, greens, and slow-cooked meals.
- Add iron-rich options like beets, spinach, lentils, chickpeas, tofu, pumpkin seeds, quinoa, black beans, fortified cereals, dried apricots, and dark leafy greens (or lean meats if preferred) to restore what's lost. Over-the-counter iron supplements are also an option.
- Choose gentle movement such as stretching, walking, or yoga to support circulation without added stress.
- Practice stillness. **Extra rest** is productive during this phase.

Understanding“Extra Rest”

Extra rest during this phase doesn't mean doing nothing; it's about creating gentle routines that support recovery. Your body is renewing blood and, balancing hormones as it resets. So, give your body the care it deserves.

Below are some do's and don'ts to guide you toward deeper renewal.

Do's:

- Sleep 8–9 hours each night and allow short naps if needed.
- Choose quiet, restorative activities such as reading, journaling, meditation, or gentle stretching.
- Take time off intense exercise or social demands to recharge.
- Keep your environment warm and calm — soft lighting, cozy blankets, and soothing music.

Don'ts:

- Push through fatigue or ignore signs of exhaustion.
- Over-schedule yourself or commit to demanding projects.
- Skip meals, over-caffeinate, or restrict calories.
- Force high-intensity workouts or long fasting periods.

By allowing yourself more rest and slowing your pace, you give your body the energy it needs to replenish and prepare for the active phases ahead.

Ovulation“Superpower” Phase(Days 10–15)

Your body is radiant and powerful. Estrogen, testosterone, and progesterone peak, giving you confidence, energy, and sparkle. This is your time to shine, connect, and move with joy.

Here's how to support that natural momentum:

- Eat colorful foods full of polyphenols and probiotics, like berries, sauerkraut, and yogurt.
- Include polyphenol-rich beverages like green tea to support antioxidant and anti-inflammatory balance.
- Try moderate fasting (up to 15 hours) if energy is high. **Listen to your cues.**

WhatDoes“ListeningtoYourCues”Mean?

“Listening to your cues” means tuning in to what your body is telling you rather than following rigid rules. During ovulation, hormones often make you feel energized and motivated, but that doesn't mean every day will be the same.

Mentioned below are a few examples of cues to listen to:

- If you wake up hungry: break your fast earlier. Your body is asking for fuel.
- If you feel energized and focused: a slightly longer fast (up to 15 hours) may feel natural. Your body is signaling readiness and stability.
- If you become lightheaded, irritable, or anxious: end your fast and eat something nourishing. Your body is asking for support.
- If cravings feel stronger: it might be a sign your metabolism is running higher. Honor that need with balanced meals. Your body is asking for more consistent nourishment.
- If sleep is disrupted or mood dips: shorten fasting windows or add a light evening snack. Your body is signaling a need for balance and steadiness.

The goal isn't to control your body; it's to partner with it. By responding to your body's real-time signals, you support steady energy, hormone harmony, and a positive relationship with food. This is a great time for creative work, workouts, and social connection. Celebrate how alive you feel; you've earned this glow.

Luteal Phase(Post-Ovulation)

Your body is preparing and protecting. Progesterone rises and your metabolism shifts, which means cravings increase, and that's okay. You're moving into your **Nurture Phase**. This is a good time to soften your pace and respond to what your body is asking for.

- Include comforting carbs and healthy fats, like sweet potatoes, quinoa, avocado, and olive oil.
- Reduce fasting; Aim for steady and warm meals.
- Create calm through gentle walks, journaling, and deep breathing.
- Treat yourself like you would a dear friend, softly and patiently.

Pre-Menstruation Phase(Week Before Menstruation)

During this phase, your body is whispering for rest. Estrogen and progesterone fall, and with them, energy naturally dips. This is not a time for pushing; it's a time for caring.

Hence, the most supportive thing you can do for yourself is:

- Choose soothing foods like soups, oats, and root vegetables.
- Avoid intense fasting. Honor hunger and comfort.
- Eat magnesium-rich foods, like pumpkin seeds, dark chocolate, and leafy greens, to ease tension.
- Prioritize early nights, cozy routines, and gentle self-compassion.

When Emotions Feel Heavier: Understanding PMDD

Some women experience stronger emotional and physical symptoms in the two weeks before their period. It's a condition known as **Premenstrual Dysphoric Disorder (PMDD)**. This is not "just PMS"; it's a more intense response to hormonal fluctuations that can affect mood, energy, and focus. The key is to recognize it early and create a nurturing plan for yourself rather than turning immediately to medication.

Common Signs of PMDD:

- Heightened irritability, sadness, or anxiety
- Fatigue or disrupted sleep
- Difficulty concentrating
- Feeling overwhelmed or withdrawn
- Physical symptoms like bloating, breast tenderness, or headaches

Healthy Coping Mechanisms:

- Prioritize consistency: Eat balanced meals with protein, complex carbs, and healthy fats to stabilize blood sugar.
- Move gently: Light exercise like walking, yoga, or stretching can lift mood and regulate cortisol.
- Rest intentionally: Maintain 7–9 hours of sleep and create calming nightly rituals (herbal tea, soft lighting, quiet music).
- Connect: Talk to a trusted friend, partner, or counselor. Sharing feelings reduces their weight.
- Mind-body care: Practices like journaling, deep breathing, and meditation calm the nervous system and support hormone balance.

Supplement Support:

Here are some options to help nurture your hormones and emotional well-being:

- Magnesium glycinate or citrate: Helps with mood swings, cramps, and sleep.
- Vitamin B6 & Methylated B-Complex: Supports serotonin production and energy.
- Calcium and Vitamin D3/K2: Reduce PMS-related bloating, pain, and irritability.
- Omega-3 fatty acids (EPA/DHA): Lower inflammation and support emotional balance.
- Adaptogenic herbs like ashwagandha, rhodiola, or chaste tree (vitex): Support hormone harmony naturally.

Avoid Jumping Straight to SSRIs:

**SSRIs, short for Selective Serotonin Reuptake Inhibitors, are the type of antidepressant often prescribed for mood-related symptoms.*

While SSRIs can be helpful for some, they don't address the underlying hormonal changes behind premenstrual emotional shifts and may come with side effects or dependency risks. For many women, lifestyle shifts, nutritional support, and targeted supplementation can bring meaningful relief without medication. If symptoms remain severe, it's recommended to work with your primary care provider who can test hormone levels and tailor your care. After all, your body's rhythm deserves to be understood, not suppressed.

Actionable Tips for Every Phase

Eat With Intention:

Fuel your body with whole foods, healthy fats, protein, and fiber. Your hormones thrive on stability.

Listen to Your Body:

If you're tired, rest. If you crave, nourish. Your intuition is your greatest guide.

Support Estrogen:

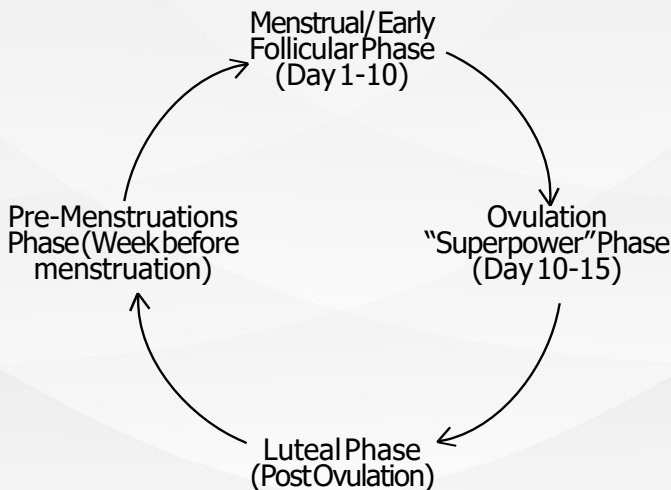
Feed your gut with prebiotics and probiotics. Your microbiome helps clear excess estrogen.

Replenish:

During your menstrual cycle, refuel with iron, minerals, and hydration. Think spinach, eggs, broth, and water.

Remember, your body is your lifelong companion.

When you care for yourself through every phase, you build balance, strength, and lasting harmony.



Did you know?

- Women's bodies are more efficient at using fat for fuel than men's, especially during endurance activity.
- Muscle tissue helps regulate blood sugar, not just strength or appearance.
- Hormonal fluctuations can influence how the body responds to exercise on different days of the month.
- Estrogen supports brain function, bone strength, and cardiovascular health—not just reproductive health.
- Chronic stress can reduce how effectively cells respond to other hormones.
- Women's brains show stronger connections between the left and right hemispheres, supporting multitasking and emotional processing.
- Women's skin is thinner than men's, which affects hydration, sensitivity, and aging patterns.